ABSOLUTE / UPAJ

Upaj: recurring utility for farmers

Farmer journeys built around monitoring, market information, content and timely notifications.

Role: Product leadership across the Absolute portfolio | Period: October 2021–November 2024

Reported outcomes and scope

+50% / +20% · Reported D14 / D30 retention lift

100K → 600K · Reported active-user growth

−66% · Reported CAC change

The product problem

Upaj's Day-14 and Day-30 retention had remained stagnant after launch, with UI and UX problems identified in the revamp brief. Farmers needed useful information in a form that fitted daily decisions, low-end devices and uneven connectivity.

My role

I led product work on the app revamp and platform monetisation, coordinating experience design, content, notifications and farm-information features. The work stayed close to farmer needs rather than treating engagement as notification volume alone.

What I built

The revamped journey brought together farm monitoring, mandi prices and a new notification structure. Content used long-form YouTube material and shorter custom-CDN formats, with rural creators contributing to the library.

Onboarding and device-performance work supported that larger redesign. The product programme connected the information farmers wanted, the route to reaching it and the constraints of using the app in the field.

A product organised around recurring decisions

I led the UI and UX revamp after Day-14 and Day-30 retention had stayed flat for thirteen months. The redesign combined farm monitoring, mandi prices and a new push-notification structure. These covered recurring jobs: observe the farm, check a market and receive relevant information, rather than treating the visual refresh as a separate result.

Content had its own delivery design. I worked with rural influencers and creators to build the library, using YouTube for material longer than a minute and a custom CDN for shorter formats. The choice connected content length, distribution and the mobile experience. The records describe the content work as part of the overall engagement programme, with no content-only retention attribution.

Onboarding, phones and notifications

Later portfolio material expands the revamp into onboarding and device-performance work: an eleven-step entry flow reduced to three, and attention to app size and cold-start behaviour on constrained Android devices. These describe supporting workstreams, while the earlier CV establishes the wider UI/UX, information-feature and retention result.

The notification structure also moved closer to farming context, with later material describing crop-cycle triggers. Design and engineering work therefore sat alongside content and lifecycle communication. I owned platform monetisation as part of the remit, while the engagement metrics report the programme's performance rather than a standalone revenue result for any one feature.

What changed

The revamp reports a 50% improvement in Day-14 retention and 20% in Day-30 retention over its first three months. The Professional Profile also reports active users moving from 100,000 to 600,000, CAC falling 66%, and average session duration increasing from 11 to 15 minutes. Each describes a different aspect of the programme.

The lesson from this work

This case demonstrates engagement built around a recurring job: information that helps a farmer monitor, plan or sell. Retention, acquisition economics and time spent provide different views of that usefulness and should retain their original definitions.

Visual references and walkthroughs

Upaj: Growstac personalised

Upaj: Growstac personalised Public reference captured on 13 October 2026.

Documented workflow: Farmer tasks and needs → Farm monitoring and mandi utility → Notifications and useful content → Repeat engagement → D14 and D30 measurement

An authored explanation of the workflow described in this case study. This is a diagram, not a captured product screen.

View the online case study for the full image gallery and playable videos.

Evidence and attribution

Public Upaj pages captured in 2026 provide product context after the documented employment period.

Retention baselines, cohort sizes and relative-versus-point definitions are not supplied. Onboarding and constrained-device details appear in later material and have no isolated measured effect. Broad company farmer reach is separate from the active-user series.